

Introduction to Spreadsheets

Learning Objectives

- Define spreadsheet and its purpose in data management
- Identify rows, columns, cells, and cell references
- Open LibreOffice Calc and navigate the interface

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a shopkeeper's ledger book where he writes items, quantities, and prices in neat rows and columns. A spreadsheet is a digital ledger—same rows and columns, but with the power to calculate, sort, and analyze data automatically.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open LibreOffice Calc. Explore the interface—identify the formula bar, cell reference box, column headers (A, B, C), and row numbers (1, 2, 3). Click on different cells and note their references. Type your name in cell A1 and a number in B1. Save the file.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

A spreadsheet is a grid of rows and columns used to organize and analyze data. Each intersection is a cell identified by its column letter and row number (like A1, B2). The formula bar shows cell contents. Spreadsheets are used for calculations, data analysis, charting, and record-keeping in schools, businesses, and farms.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a simple inventory for your school library. In column A, list 5 book titles. In column B, write the number of copies. In column C, note the condition (Good/Fair). Use proper cell references for each entry. Count how many cells you used and write the total.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Answer: What is a cell reference? Why are spreadsheets better than paper ledgers? Name three real-life uses of spreadsheets in your village.